

28

Many verbs can be followed by another verb. This can be a "to" infinitive ("want to eat") or a gerund ("enjoy cooking").

 **New language** Combining verbs

## Aa Vocabulary Office tasks

 **New skill** Taking part in meetings

### 28.1 KEY LANGUAGE VERBS FOLLOWED BY "TO" OR "-ING" (NO CHANGE IN MEANING)

Some verbs can be followed by a gerund (an “-ing” form) or a “to” infinitive, with little or no change in meaning. You can often use both forms interchangeably.



Emails are really awkward. I prefer { meeting to meet } in person.

I like  $\left\{ \begin{array}{l} \text{working} \\ \text{to work} \end{array} \right\}$  in an open-plan office with a team.



## 28.2 MATCH THE BEGINNINGS OF THE SENTENCES TO THE CORRECT ENDINGS

Oh no. It's James! Once he **starts**

to run for the bus.

1 He was fired because he **continued**

being cold and wet.

2 How would you propose

writing to people by hand.

3 I was so late that I **began**

talking, he never stops.

4 Let's go inside. I really **can't stand**

to ignore his duties.

5 I have to say that I **prefer**

to raise the money?

**TIP**

These verbs can all be followed by "to" or "-ing" with no change in meaning.

